



Why Your Website Is Not Visible on Google

Google Search Console

What It Is and Why You Need It

Setup & Indexing Guide

Step-by-step account creation & property setup

How to Make Your Website Visible on Google

DNS, HTML file, and meta tag methods

✓ Step-by-Step instructions

✓ Visual Screenshots

✓ Complete Checklist

Help Google discover all your pages

Request indexing for specific pages

Coverage report and common error fixes

Quick reference for the full process

Understanding the Problem

When you build a website, it does NOT automatically appear on Google. Google uses automated programs called **crawlers (Googlebot)** to discover and index web pages. If your site is new or misconfigured, Google may not know it exists — meaning zero visitors from search.

■ Common Reasons Your Site Is Not Visible

- Website is brand new — Google hasn't crawled it yet (can take weeks)
- No sitemap submitted — Google doesn't know all your pages
- robots.txt is blocking Googlebot from crawling your site
- Pages have noindex meta tags preventing indexing
- Website has technical errors (broken links, server errors)
- Domain has no backlinks — low crawl priority

■ NOTE

The solution to all these problems is **Google Search Console (GSC)** — Google's free tool that lets you monitor your site's presence in search results, submit sitemaps, request indexing, and fix errors.

Google Search Console Overview

Google Search Console is a free web service provided by Google. It helps website owners, SEO specialists, and developers monitor, maintain, and troubleshoot their site's presence in Google Search results.

Feature	What It Does
Performance Report	Shows clicks, impressions, CTR, and average ranking position
URL Inspection	Check if a specific page is indexed and request re-crawling
Coverage Report	See all indexed pages and any errors preventing indexing
Sitemap Submission	Tell Google all the pages that exist on your website
Core Web Vitals	Monitor page speed and user experience scores
Security Issues	Get alerted if Google detects malware or hacked content
Manual Actions	See if Google has penalized your site for violations

What Google Search Console Looks Like

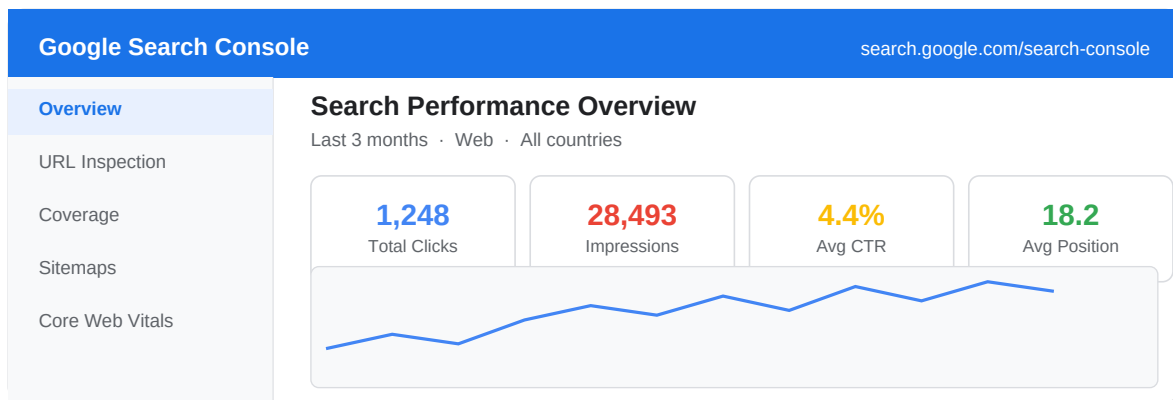


Figure 1: Google Search Console dashboard showing performance metrics

Setting Up Google Search Console

Follow these steps carefully to set up your account:

1 Go to Google Search Console

Open your browser and navigate to: search.google.com/search-console Make sure you are signed in to the Google account that manages your website.

URL to visit:

<https://search.google.com/search-console/welcome>

2 Click 'Add Property'

If this is your first time, you will see a welcome screen. Click 'Start Now'. If you already have properties, click the property dropdown at the top left and select 'Add property'.

3 Choose Your Property Type

Google offers two options. Choose the one that fits your setup:

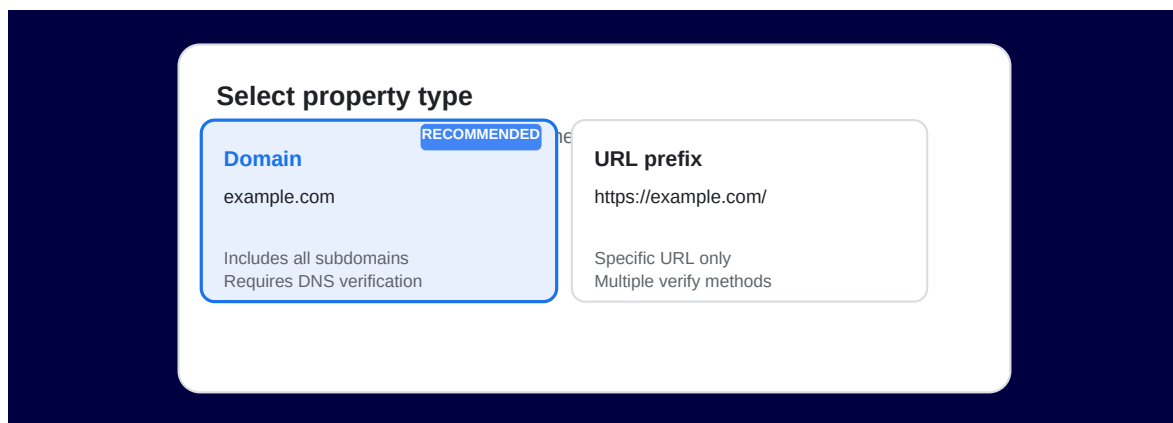


Figure 2: Choosing between Domain property and URL prefix property

Property Type	Best For	Verification Method
Domain (example.com)	Covers ALL subdomains and protocols (http, https, www, non-www)	DNS TXT record ONLY
URL Prefix (https://example.com/)	Covers only the specific URL prefix entered	Multiple methods available

■ TIP

Recommendation: Use **Domain property** if possible. It gives you the most complete data by combining all versions of your site (www, non-www, http, https) into one property.

Verifying Website Ownership

Google requires you to prove you own the website before giving you access. There are several verification methods. The DNS method is the most reliable for Domain properties.

Method 1: DNS TXT Record (Recommended for Domain properties)

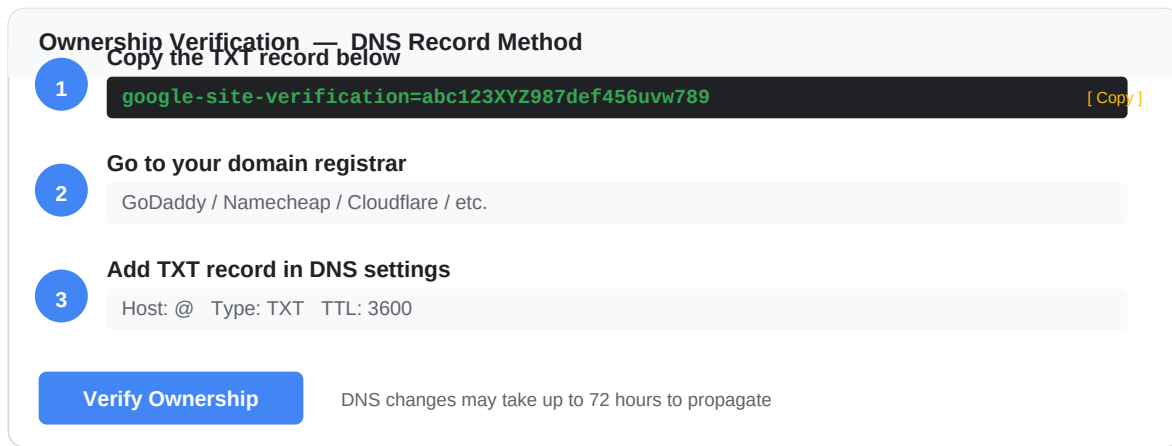


Figure 3: DNS verification screen showing the TXT record to copy

1 Copy the TXT record

Google will give you a code like: `google-site-verification=AbCdEf123...` Copy the entire string.

2 Log in to your domain registrar

This is where you bought your domain: GoDaddy, Namecheap, Cloudflare, Google Domains, etc.

3 Find DNS Management

Look for 'DNS Settings', 'DNS Records', 'Zone Editor', or 'Name Servers' in your registrar's control panel.

4 Add a new TXT record

Type: TXT Host/Name: @ (or leave blank) Value: Paste the Google verification code TTL: 3600 (or default)

5 Save and verify

Go back to Search Console and click 'Verify'. DNS changes can take up to 72 hours, but usually work within minutes.

Method 2: HTML File Upload (URL Prefix only)

Download a small HTML file from Google Search Console and upload it to your website's root directory:

- 1 Select 'HTML file' as verification method in Search Console
- 2 Download the provided HTML file (e.g., google1234abc.html)
- 3 Upload the file to the root of your website (e.g., yoursite.com/google1234abc.html)
- 4 Visit the URL in your browser to confirm it's accessible
- 5 Click 'Verify' in Search Console

Method 3: HTML Meta Tag (URL Prefix only)

Add a special meta tag to the **<head>** section of your homepage:

```
<meta name="google-site-verification" content="YOUR_VERIFICATION_CODE" />
```

■ NOTE

Place the meta tag inside the **<head>** section of your homepage HTML, before the **</head>** closing tag. Then click Verify in Search Console.

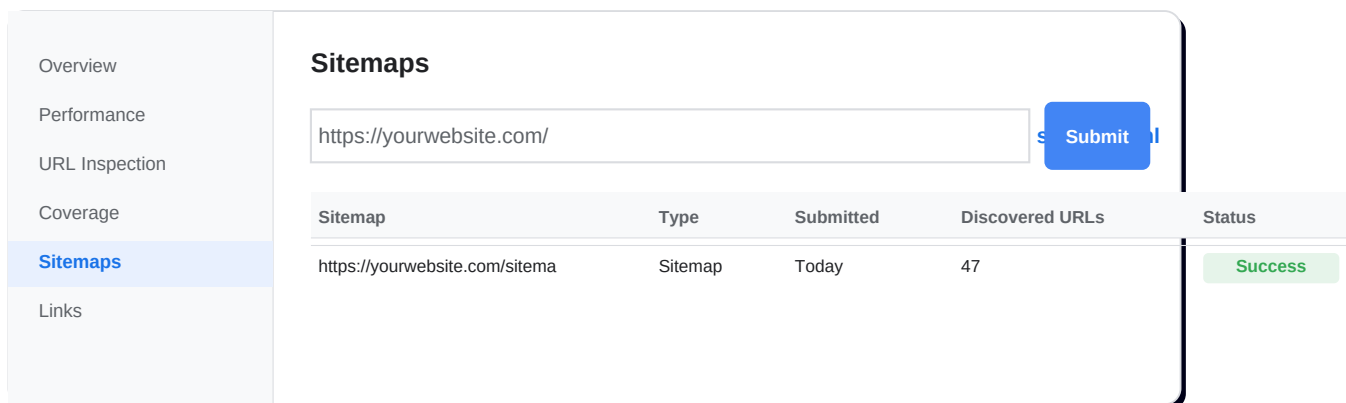
Submitting Your Sitemap

A **sitemap** is an XML file that lists all the pages on your website. Submitting it tells Google exactly what pages exist so they can be crawled and indexed faster.

■ NOTE

Most websites already have a sitemap. Common locations to check: • `yourwebsite.com/sitemap.xml`
• `yourwebsite.com/sitemap_index.xml` • `yourwebsite.com/wp-sitemap.xml` (WordPress)

Steps to Submit Your Sitemap



The screenshot shows the 'Sitemaps' section in Google Search Console. On the left is a sidebar with links: Overview, Performance, URL Inspection, Coverage, Sitemaps (highlighted), and Links. The main area is titled 'Sitemaps' and contains a text input field with the URL 'https://yourwebsite.com/' and a blue 'Submit' button. Below this is a table with the following data:

Sitemap	Type	Submitted	Discovered URLs	Status
https://yourwebsite.com/sitema	Sitemap	Today	47	Success

Figure 4: Sitemaps section in Google Search Console showing submission form and status

1 Open Sitemaps in Search Console

In the left sidebar of Google Search Console, click on 'Sitemaps' under the Indexing section.

2 Enter your sitemap URL

In the 'Add a new sitemap' field, type the path to your sitemap. Usually just: `sitemap.xml` or `sitemap_index.xml`

3 Click Submit

Press the Submit button. Google will immediately try to fetch and read your sitemap file.

4 Check the status

After submission, you should see your sitemap listed with a 'Success' status and the number of URLs discovered.

5 Monitor regularly

Check back every few weeks to ensure your sitemap is still being read successfully and no errors appear.

■ TIP

If your sitemap doesn't exist yet, plugins like Yoast SEO (WordPress), RankMath, or tools like `xml-sitemaps.com` can generate one automatically for you.

URL Inspection & Manual Indexing

Even after submitting a sitemap, individual pages may not be indexed immediately. The URL Inspection tool lets you check any specific page and request Google to crawl it manually.

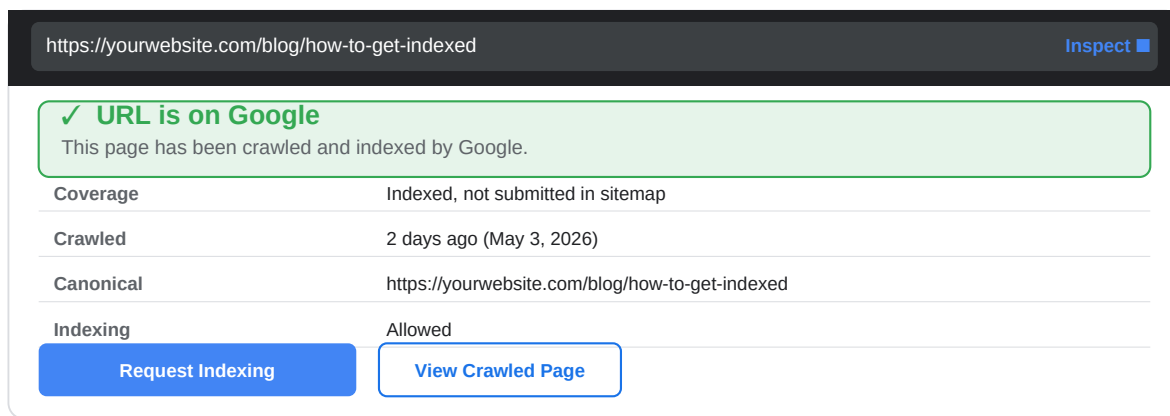


Figure 5: URL Inspection tool showing a successfully indexed page

1 Paste the URL to inspect

Click 'URL Inspection' in the left sidebar. Paste the full URL of the page you want to check (e.g., `https://yoursite.com/about`) and press Enter.

2 Read the status result

Google will show one of three statuses: • URL is on Google (indexed ✓) • URL is not on Google (not indexed) • URL is not available to Google (blocked)

3 Click 'Request Indexing'

If the page is NOT indexed, click the 'Request Indexing' button. Google will add it to its crawl queue (usually indexed within a few days to 2 weeks).

4 Check 'View Crawled Page'

This shows you exactly what Google sees when it visits your page — useful for diagnosing rendering issues with JavaScript sites.

5 Repeat for important pages

Manually request indexing for your most important pages: homepage, blog posts, product pages, contact page, etc.

■ TIP

Google allows a limited number of indexing requests per day. Prioritize your most important pages first. Submitting a sitemap is the more scalable solution for large sites.

Monitoring Coverage & Fixing Errors

The Coverage (now called 'Pages') report shows which of your pages are indexed and which have problems. Regularly checking this report is essential for maintaining good search visibility.

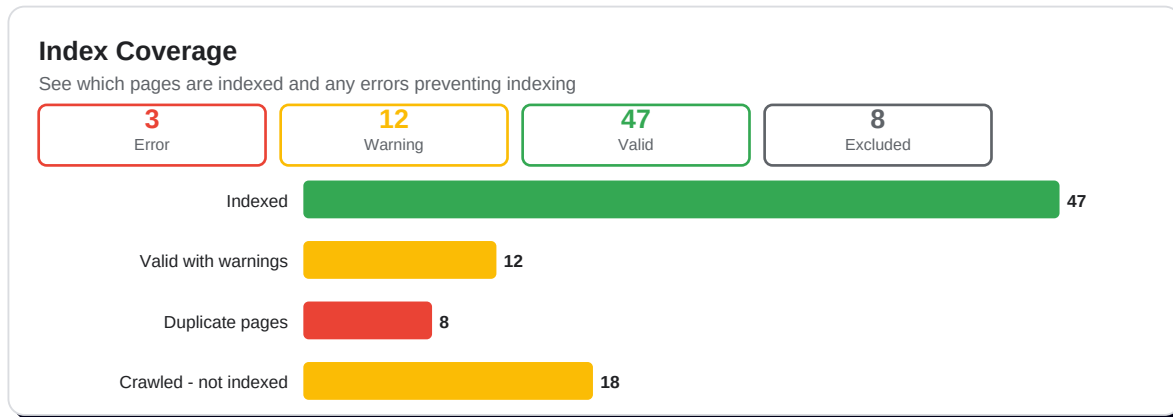


Figure 6: Index Coverage report showing page status breakdown

Understanding Coverage Status Types

Status	Color	Meaning	Action Needed
Valid	Green	Pages successfully indexed by Google	None — these are working!
Valid with warnings	Yellow	Indexed but Google noticed issues	Review and fix if important
Excluded	Grey	Not indexed (by choice or discovery)	Review — may be intentional
Error	Red	Pages that failed to be indexed	Must fix these immediately

Common Errors and How to Fix Them

■ Submitted URL blocked by robots.txt

→ Fix: Your robots.txt file is telling Google not to crawl the page. Remove the Disallow rule for that URL.

■ Submitted URL has noindex tag

→ Fix: The page has in its HTML. Remove this tag to allow indexing.

■ 404 Not Found / Page not found

→ Fix: The page doesn't exist. Fix the URL in your sitemap, or set up a proper redirect (301) if the page moved.

■ Server error (5xx)

→ Fix: Your web server had an error when Googlebot tried to visit. Check your hosting provider and server logs.

■ Crawled — currently not indexed

→ Fix: Google crawled the page but chose not to index it (usually thin content). Improve the content quality and request indexing again.

■ **Redirect error**

→ Fix: There's a redirect chain or loop. Simplify your redirects so they go directly from old URL to new URL in one hop.

CHAPTER 8

Complete Checklist

Use this checklist to ensure you've completed every step of the Google Search Console setup and indexing process:

SETUP

- ☐ Create / sign in to Google account
- ☐ Go to search.google.com/search-console
- ☐ Click 'Add Property' and enter your website URL
- ☐ Choose property type (Domain recommended)

VERIFICATION

- ☐ Copy the DNS TXT record provided by Google
- ☐ Log in to your domain registrar
- ☐ Add TXT record: Host=@, Type=TXT, Value=google-site-verification=...
- ☐ Return to Search Console and click 'Verify'
- ☐ Confirmation: Green checkmark and 'Ownership verified'

SITEMAP

- ☐ Locate your sitemap URL (usually /sitemap.xml)
- ☐ Navigate to Indexing → Sitemaps in Search Console
- ☐ Enter sitemap URL and click Submit
- ☐ Confirm status shows 'Success' with URL count

INDEXING

- ☐ Use URL Inspection for key pages
- ☐ Request indexing for homepage, about, services/products, blog posts
- ☐ Wait 3-14 days for pages to appear in search
- ☐ Test by searching: `site:yourwebsite.com` in Google

ONGOING MONITORING

- ☐ Check Coverage/Pages report monthly
- ☐ Fix any Errors immediately
- ☐ Monitor Performance for clicks and impressions growth
- ☐ Update sitemap when adding new pages

■ Check Core Web Vitals for page speed issues

✓ SUCCESS

After completing all steps, search for your website on Google using: **site:yourwebsite.com** This shows all indexed pages. If results appear, your website is visible on Google!